



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2022 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05285) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Fall 2022**

Courses Audience: **61**

Responses Received: **31**

Response Ratio: **50.8%**

Report Comments

Results were produced during the Fall 2022 implementation of new course evaluation questions and systems. Courses with final exams conducted on December 8th, 2022, may have overlapped with the evaluation window.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

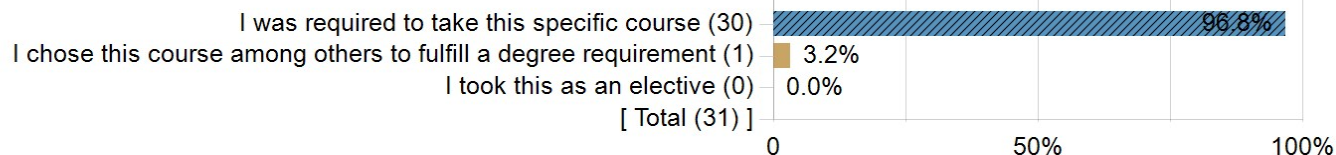
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

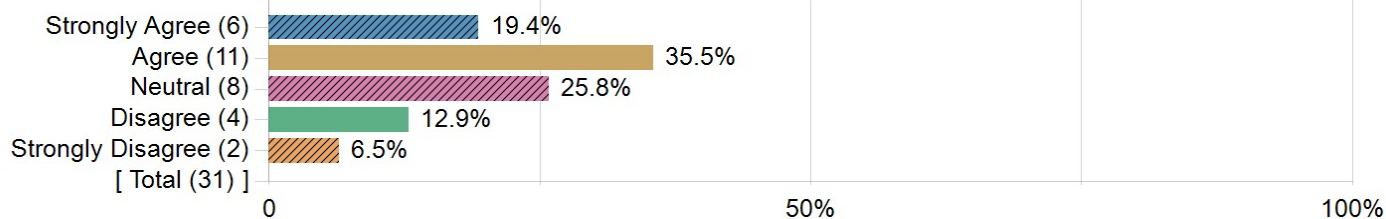
Creation Date: **Friday, May 5, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



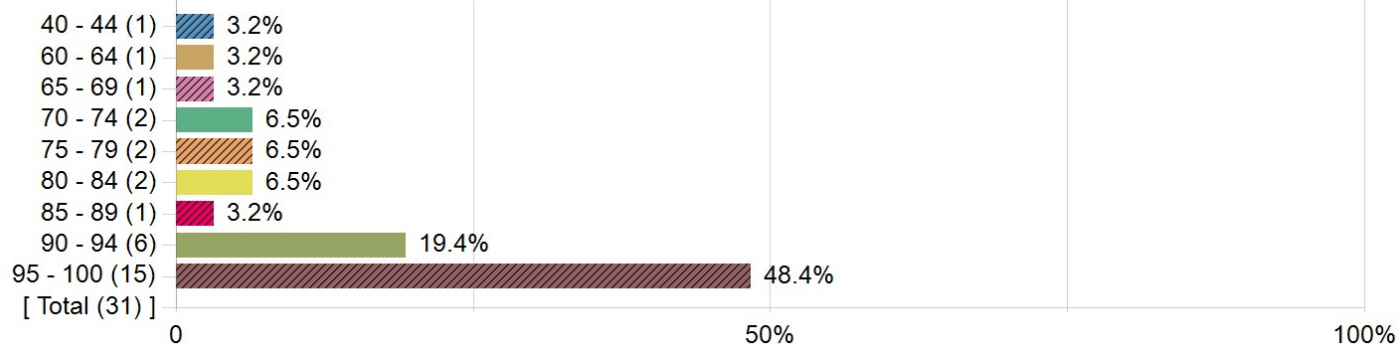
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.48

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



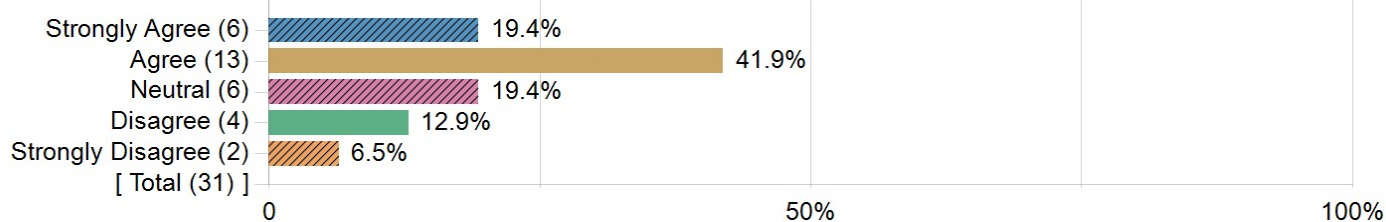
Statistics

Value

Mean

87.87

The course assignments improved my ability to apply logical, numerical, or statistical skills to real-world problems.



Statistics

Value

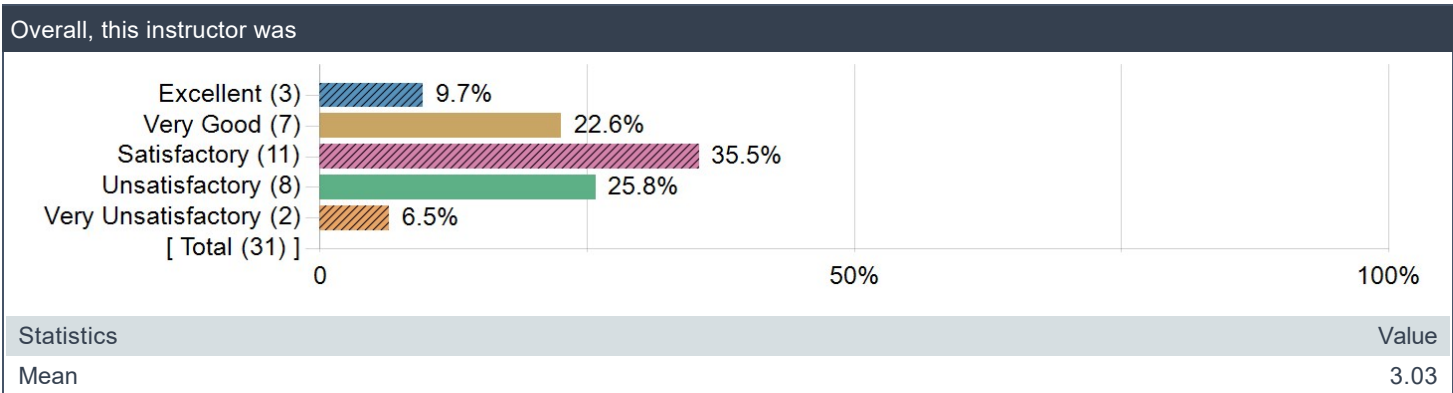
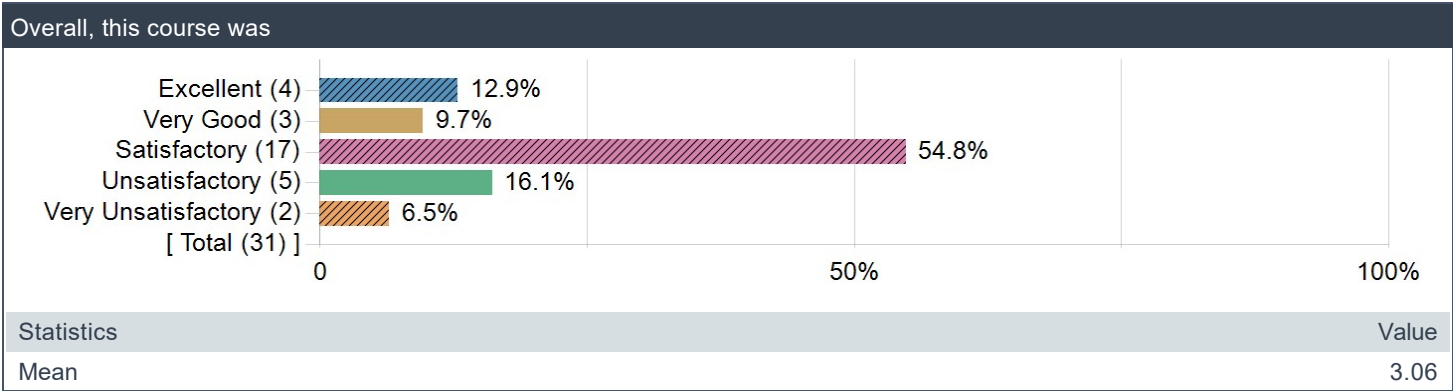
Mean

3.55

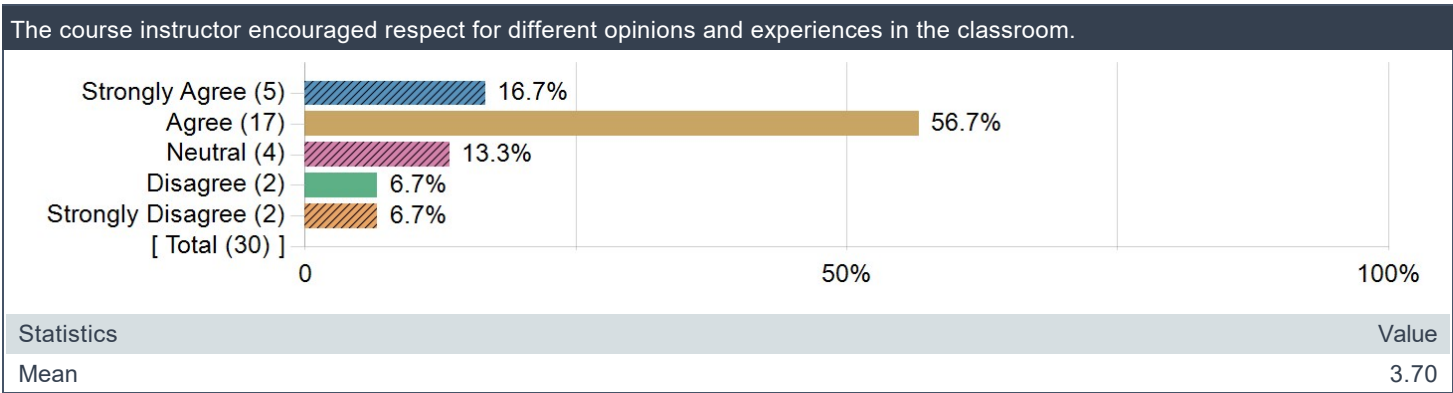
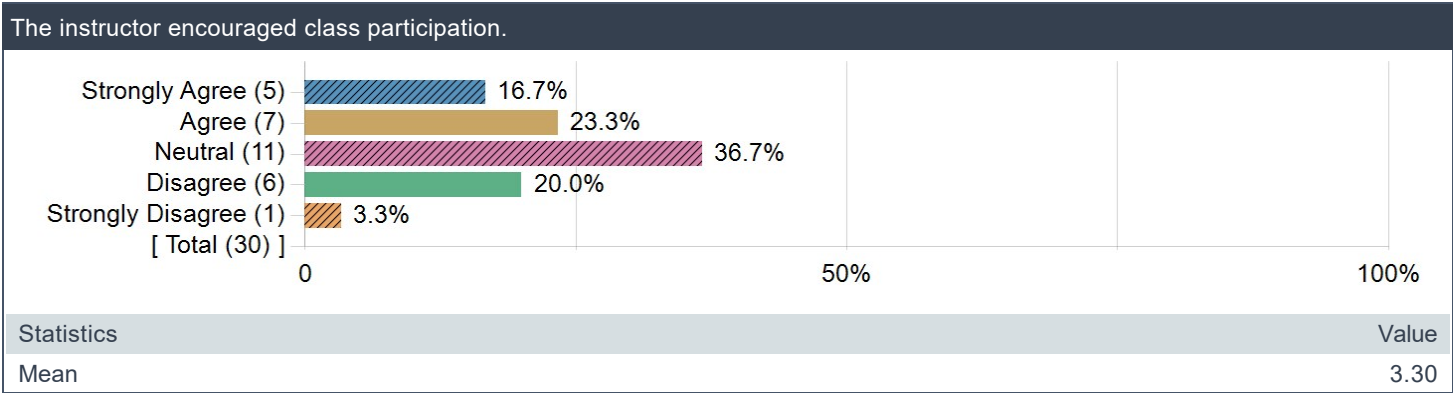
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	16.1%	35.5%	32.3%	12.9%	3.2%	31	3.48
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	22.6%	38.7%	32.3%	3.2%	3.2%	31	3.74
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	9.7%	32.3%	29.0%	19.4%	9.7%	31	3.13
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	12.9%	12.9%	25.8%	29.0%	19.4%	31	2.71
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	19.4%	25.8%	32.3%	19.4%	3.2%	31	3.39

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Doing R Studio in class.
Nothing
good textbook
The online text–book.
The textbook
The Kc we did in terms of homework was great for practice that we could always go back to and review.
I liked when the teacher showed us the R code
Being able to do our knowledge checks as much as we wanted to get the score we desired helped me learn by having to do it over and over if I did not fully understand the topic.
When the professor would explain concepts through R.
The TA's did an excellent job at R Practice Session and R Review Sessions, but this was about the only resource I found helpful.
when we would help us with coding
The assignments and textbook helped me learn the most.
I really disliked the structe and teacher for this course. Not much I was successful in besides the TA's being better than the teacher himself
Quizzes
KC after each class
The amount of office hours was the most effective because there was office hours almost every day at all hours of the day, so I felt like there was always someone available to answer my questions whenever I needed.
reading the textbook
Reading the textbook and reviewing the curriculum in class
The KCs were good as they required me to always be on top of the subject matter
When he would do examples with us in R Studio, but he very rarely did this.
KC's
hes pretty chill and pretty funny.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Not read off slides and actually showing us what to do rather than just explaining.
All
lectures were a bit hard to understand/follow
The concepts and limited examples.
The knowledge check and unclear lectures
I found the lack of explanation of Rstudio which is a key component of this course to be most challenging. This program is used to answer the questions we learn in this course but we are taught very little about how to use this site which is coding. We are expected to self-teach ourselves this skill by reading the textbook which isn't always helpful. There needs to be a period of time when we learn how to code whether it's optional or not.
Applying the R Code on its own because the teacher going on rambles or is unorganized.
I feel that the coding aspect of the course should be taught more thoroughly.
The code is like a foreign language, you don't have much time to get used to the R language, the pacing feels fast.
sometimes a little hard to understand, also sometimes taught like we already knew the subject matter and went too fast
I found the tests to be the most challenging. I would suggest for the professor to dedicate one class before the exams for studying and reviewing for the exam, and maybe even providing a review of sorts.
not able to understand the teacher who is a smart guy but horrible teacher, has terrible handwriting, very very very thick accent, doesn't lecture based off the notes, was not engaging, honestly turned an interesting class with cool subject matter into probably the worst class I have ever taken
Test
The content and the amount of work given is excessive.
the instructor couldn't speak English very well which made the lecture feel pointless to attend.
Learning to program using R studio. N/A
I wish there was a practice exam for the final like there was for the midterm
Explain things better and do examples with us in class.
I felt that we didn't spend as much time with R as we should have in class, making the KC's difficult often.
one aspect I found most challenging is R. R studio is pretty hard and tricky to learn.